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Peking
3rd September 1874.

No 186

My Lord,

In my despatch No 177 of the 10th August I referred to the unguardedness with which the Ministers of the Yamên speak of their present relations with Japan.

In reply to my communication (Enclosure in despatch No 165 of the 3rd August) on the subject of the Massacre that it was rumoured

The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

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rumoured would take place on the 8th August, I had received a half frantic semi-official note to the effect that the unreasonableness and hostile attitude of the Japanese were disquieting the minds of the people. Hence the prevalence of such reports as that I had denounced.

I took the note back to the Yamên and pointed out to the Ministers who received me that language of this kind might be made use

use of, by any one of ~~265~~ unfriendly dispositions, to prejudice the case of China and Japan. The note was withdrawn and the official reply was substituted for it which forms Inclosure No. 5 in my despatch No. 183 of this date reporting the projected rising of the disaffected troops.

My remonstrance as above led to a series of conferences in which, the helplessness of China being fully admitted, I urged the necessity of such improvement of relations with foreign Powers as would

insure

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ensure their good offices
should a rupture with
Japan become imminent.

One of my objects
in sending Mr Edwardes
to Chefoo was to induce
M. de Geofroy to return
to Peking, as whatever
action may be considered
expedient will have to
be taken collectively. But
I do not expect him to
leave Chefoo, unless the
Yamên should have
some definite proposal to
make, and though much
alarmed, the Ministers
of

of the Yamên are still a
long way from a direct
application even for the
advice of foreign Representatives.

I have the honour to be
with the highest respect
My Lord
Your Lordship's most
humble obedient Servant
Thomas Francis Wade.

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1874

Peking 3 Sept.

Sir T. Wade

No. 186

Recd. Nov 17

Japan & China.
Conferences and
state of mind of
Chinese Govt.

X